25 Life Lessons I Wish I Learned Before I Turned 25

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 17, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-2wIBnw8EuA Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, 45, distills 25 lessons from surviving his father's suicide, the 2008 crash, and grinding from three jobs to multiple 7–8-figure businesses—covering money, body, business, relationships, and mindset.

📑 Contents

- 🔥 Origin Story: Tragedy, Crisis, and the Grind That Followed
- 💵 Money Lesson 1: Learn to Sell Time Before You Escape Selling Time
- ⏰ Money Lesson 2: Work Hard Before Disaster Strikes
- 🥾 Money Lesson 3: Bootstrap—Don't Chase Investors
- 📊 Money Lesson 4: Know Your Numbers Cold
- ✨ Money Lesson 5: Don't Chase Shiny Objects—Compound One Thing
- 🥗 Body Lesson 6: You Cannot Out-Train a Bad Diet
- 🥩 Body Lesson 7: Eat Protein Like It's Your Job
- 🥤 Body Lesson 8: Stop Drinking Your Calories
- 🏋️ Body Lesson 9: Don't Lift with Your Ego
- 🌱 Body Lesson 10: Build Your Foundation Young
- 💼 Business Lesson 11: Learn to Sell Before Everything Else
- 📱 Business Lesson 12: Content Is the Cheapest Lead Generation
- 📋 Business Lesson 13: Get Everything Out of Your Head into SOPs
- 🔧 Business Lesson 14: Hire Out What You Hate (Hourly Rate Framework)
- 🚀 Business Lesson 15: Adopt New Tools Aggressively
- 👥 People Lesson 16: You Become Your Environment
- 🤝 People Lesson 17: Learn to Negotiate
- 😊 People Lesson 18: Be Likeable—Ask About Others
- 🏆 People Lesson 19: Help Others Get Results
- 🧠 Mindset Lesson 20: Discipline Is Overrated
- 🎯 Mindset Lesson 21: Focus Only on What You Can Control
- 🌠 Mindset Lesson 22: Set Goals Beyond Your Comfort Zone
- 📝 Mindset Lesson 23: Write Your Own Rules
- 📈 Mindset Lesson 24: Everything Compounds

🔥 Origin Story: Tragedy, Crisis, and the Grind That Followed 0:00

- At age 24, Brandon's father died by suicide, just before his 25th birthday
  - Simultaneously, the 2008 Great Financial Crisis hit: Lehman Brothers collapsed, banks froze, unemployment hit **10%**—the highest since the Great Depression
  - Brandon suddenly became the male head of household, responsible for his mother, sister, her son, and grandmother, plus clearing his father's debts and bills
- With a college degree but no job available, he stacked multiple income streams for **2 years straight, 7 days a week, 12–14 hours a day**
  - Woke at **5:30 AM** to train clients → gym shower → train from Harlem to SoHo → **8-hour security guard shift at Prada** (his words: